

VERIDIAN
COMICS

ISSUE

07

\$4.99 US

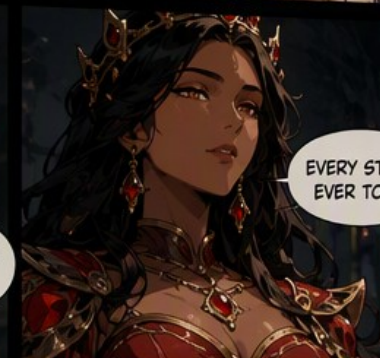
"SOMETIMES THE
HEAVIEST WEIGHT
IS WHAT YOU
CAN'T REMEMBER."

ECHOES OF STATIC

E. RAVESCROFT

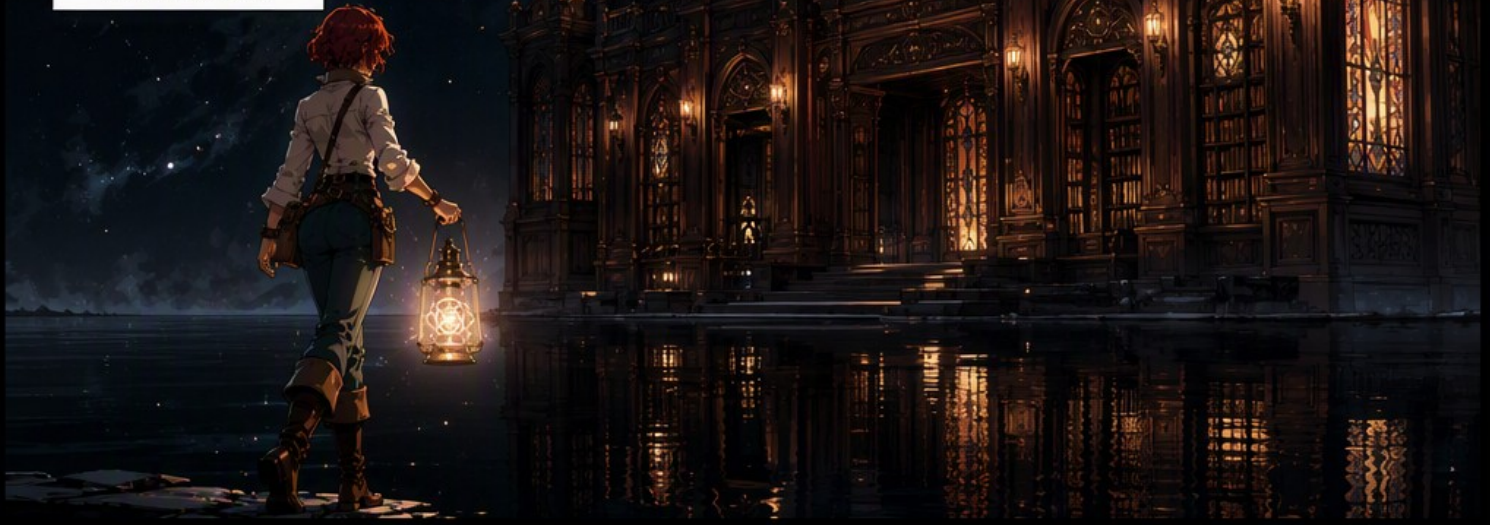
M. PARKER

NELN
J. LUX



A READING ROOM
MAROONED IN THE
COSMIC DARK.

WHOEVER BUILT THIS
WANTED IT FOUND.
OR NEVER LEFT.



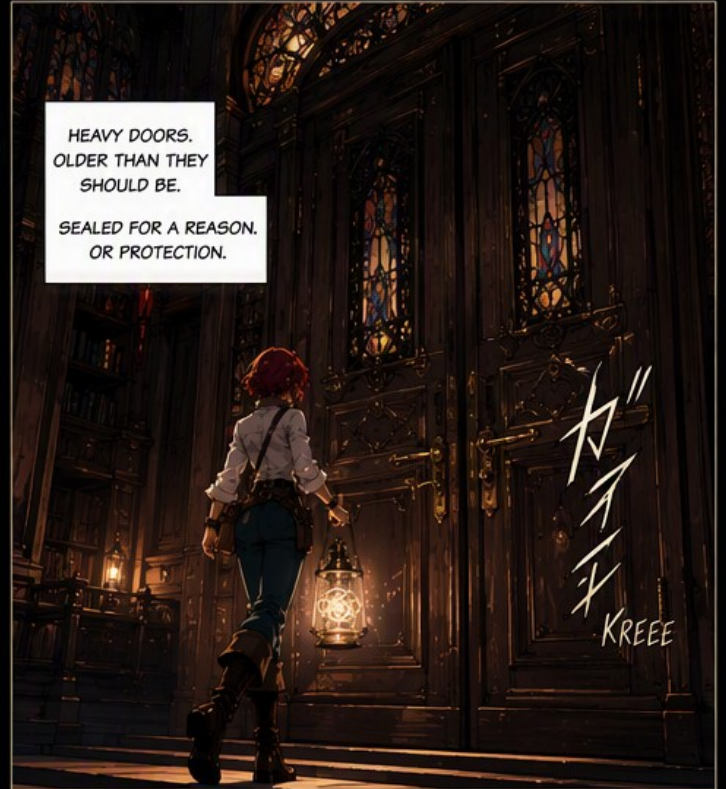
WELL.

LET'S SEE WHAT
SECRETS YOU'RE
KEEPING.



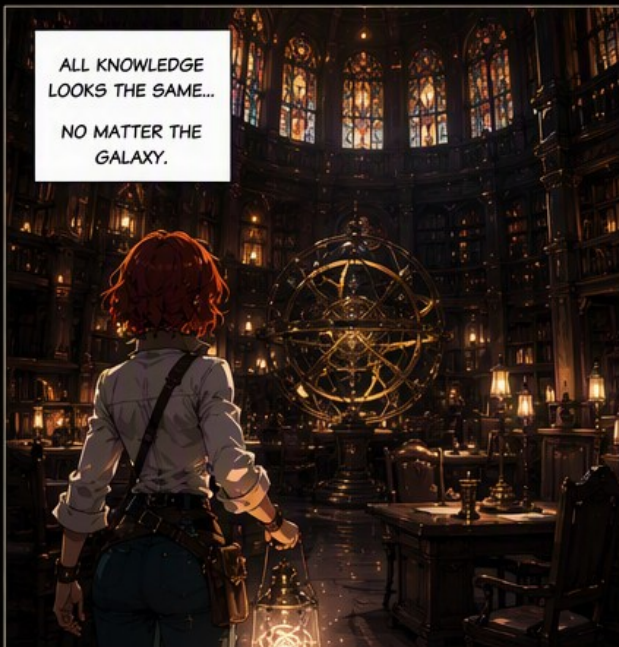
HEAVY DOORS.
OLDER THAN THEY
SHOULD BE.

SEALED FOR A REASON.
OR PROTECTION.



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KREEE

ALL KNOWLEDGE
LOOKS THE SAME...
NO MATTER THE
GALAXY.



LET'S HOPE
YOU'RE WORTH
THE TROUBLE.

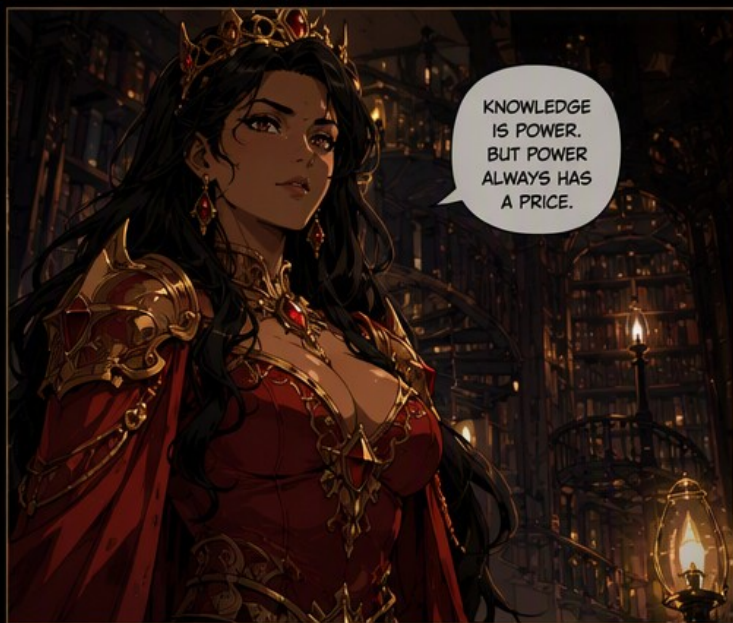


KLAK

HM.

INTERESTING.







WITH A VIOLENT
SHUDDER IN THE AIR...

...WITHIN A TEN-FOOT
RADIUS OF THE EMPRESS,

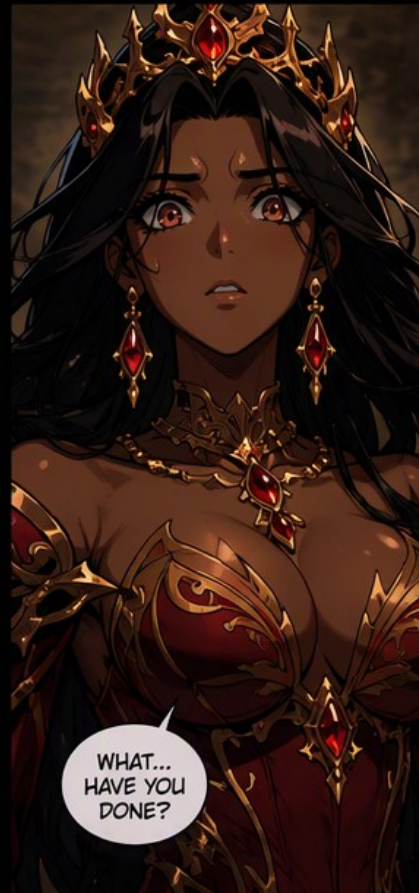


THE BOOKSHELVES
VANISH.

REPLACED INSTANTLY BY
SOLID, CLAUSTROPHOBIC
WALLS...



...COVERED IN PEELING,
HIDEOUS 1970s FLORAL
WALLPAPER.

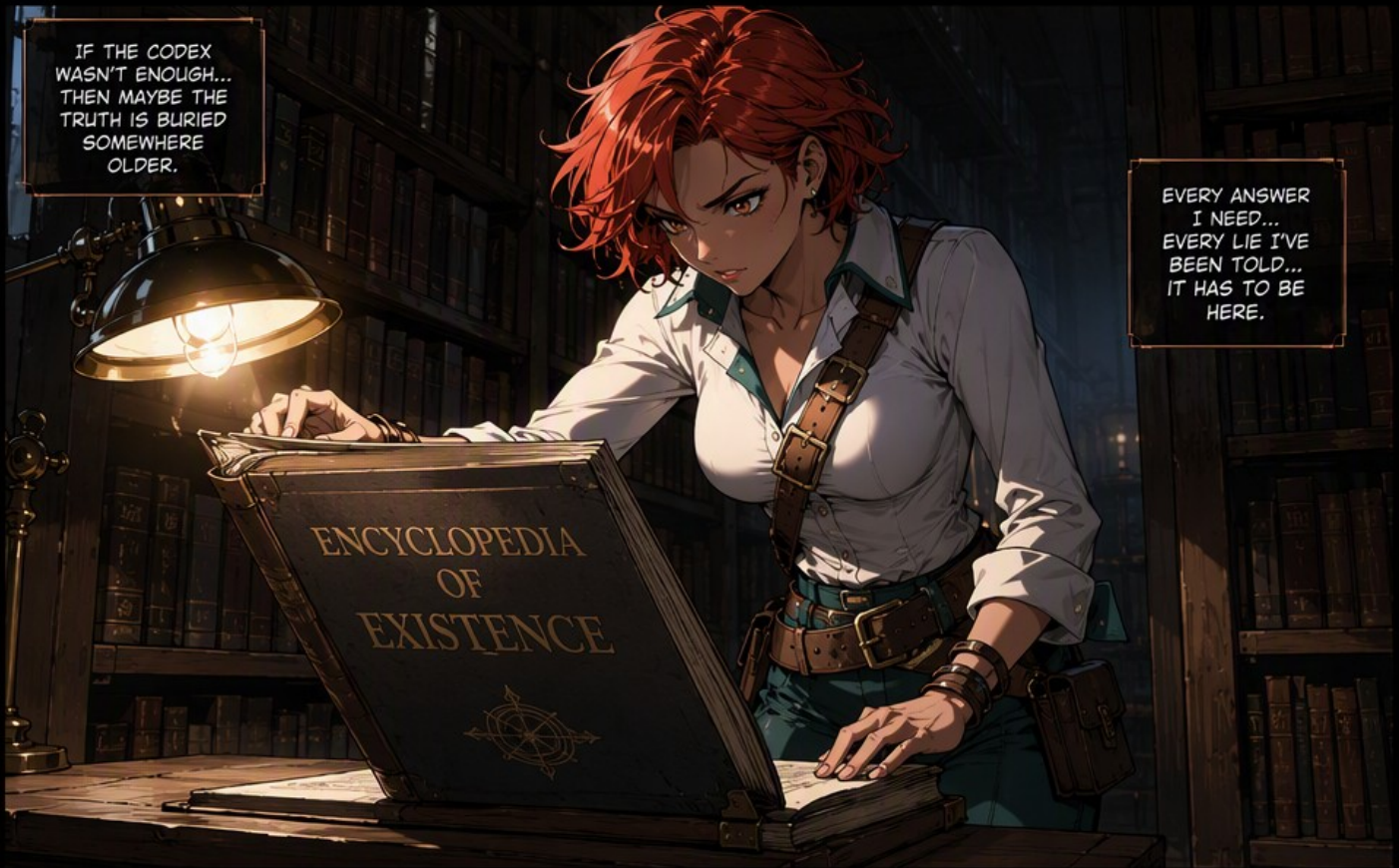


WHAT...
HAVE YOU
DONE?

THE REALITY OF
THE AISLE FUNDAMENTALLY
REWRITES ITSELF
AROUND HER.



SHE DROPS THE BOOK.



IF THE CODEX
WASN'T ENOUGH...
THEN MAYBE THE
TRUTH IS BURIED
SOMEWHERE
OLDER.

EVERY ANSWER
I NEED...
EVERY LIE I'VE
BEEN TOLD...
IT HAS TO BE
HERE.



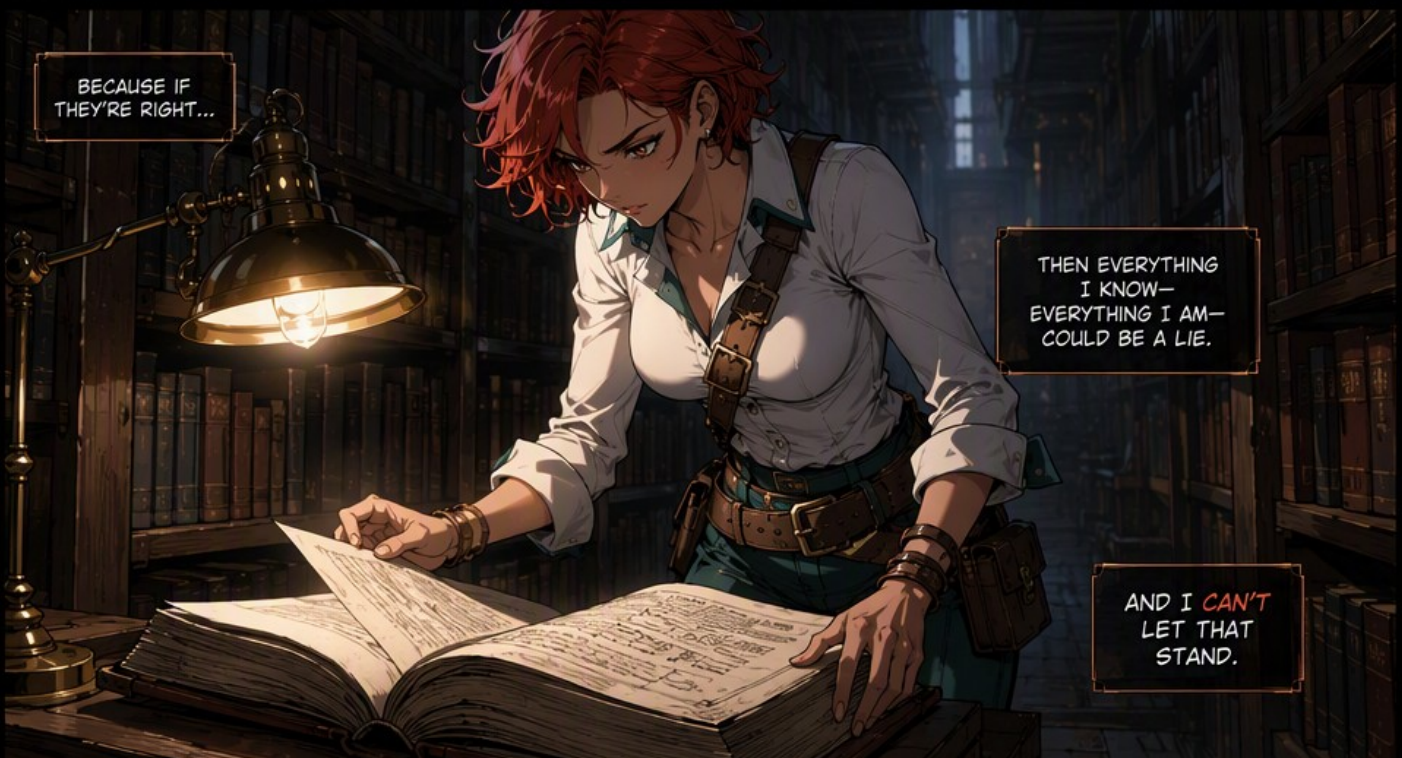
THERE'S
TOO MUCH TO READ...



NOT
ENOUGH
TIME.



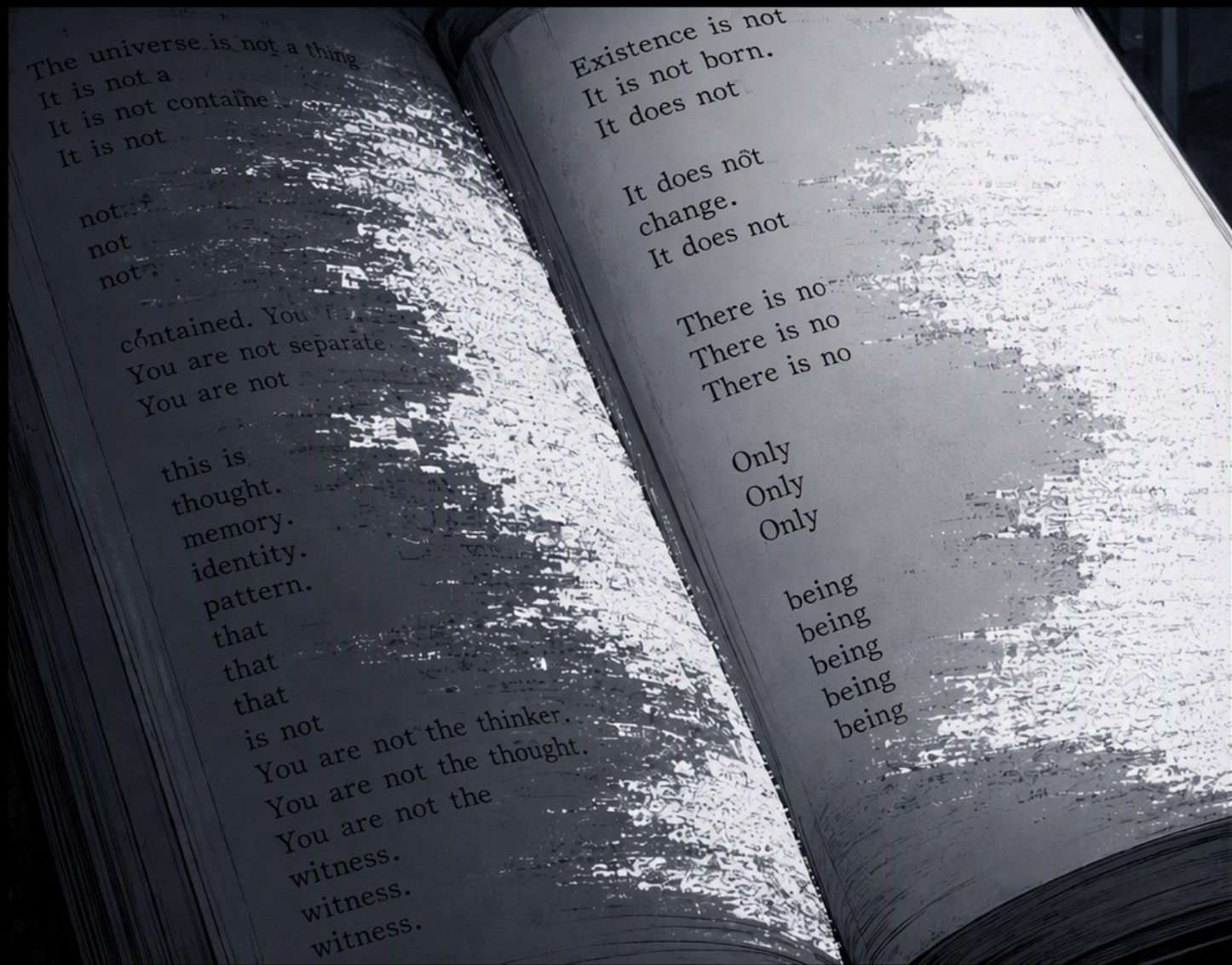
BUT I
HAVE TO
FIND IT.



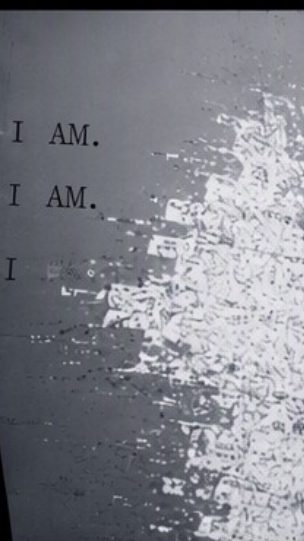
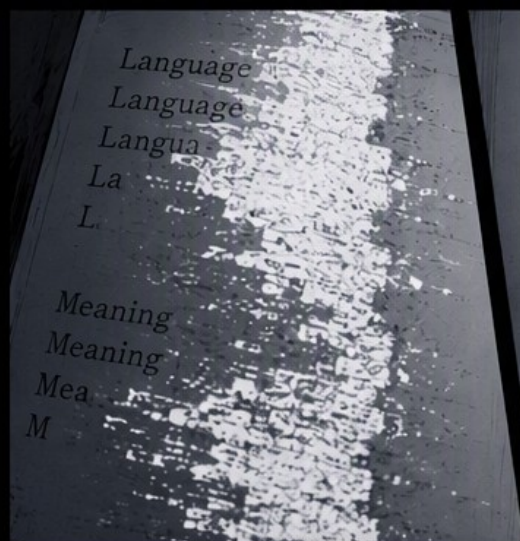
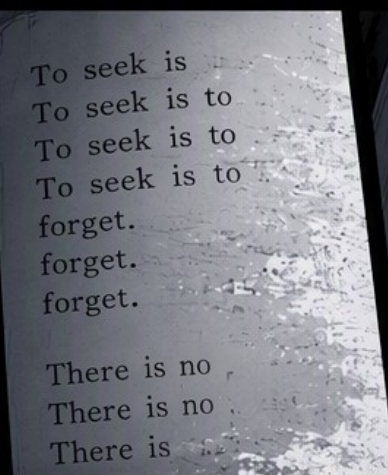
BECAUSE IF
THEY'RE RIGHT...

THEN EVERYTHING
I KNOW—
EVERYTHING I AM—
COULD BE A LIE.

AND I **CAN'T**
LET THAT
STAND.



IT'S
REWRITING
ITSELF...



IF THE BOOK
CAN FORGET...
THEN SO CAN
I.



NO... THIS CAN'T
BE RIGHT...

THE CONTEXT...
THE LINGUISTIC
ROOTS... THEY
DON'T ALIGN...



NNGH...!

NOTHING
MAKES
SENSE...!



THE WORDS...
THEY SHIFT...
THEY LOSE
MEANING...!

I CAN'T
THINK—!



N-NO...!

STOP...
MAKE IT
STOP...!



NELL!



NELL!
LOOK AT ME!

YOU'RE
SAFE.

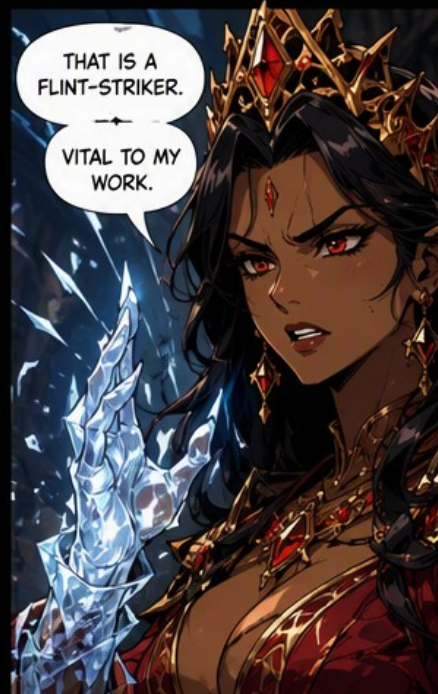
I... I
DON'T...







EZRA.
RETURN WHAT
YOU STOLE.



THAT IS A
FLINT-STRIKER.
—
VITAL TO MY
WORK.



MMRRPH!



TAK!
TAK!
TAK!
TAK!



TOO SLOW,
FIRELADY.
CATCH ME IF
YOU CAN.



YOU WILL
REGRET THAT,
LITTLE THIEF.

I WILL TURN
THE VERY AIR
TO FLAME.

AND YOU
WILL BURN.

THERMODYNAMIC FIRE

Manipulates temperature differentials to spontaneously combine oxygen and fuel in the air.

The colder the catalyst, the hotter the burn.



NOT
TODAY.



I NEED...
SOMETHING.



TREATIES...
TARIFFS...
TABOOS...

DAMMIT!



YOU DARE
INTERRUPT
MY TERMS?



Let it be understood by all realms:

A thing holds worth only in the eyes of another.

Thus value is not inherent— but agreed.

Thus... trade is the scales, and agreement is the measure.



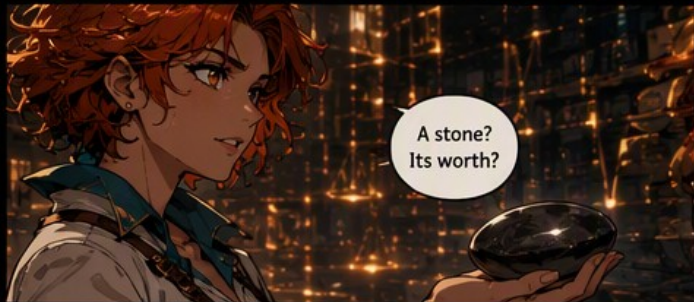
Agreement accepted.

Trade commenced!

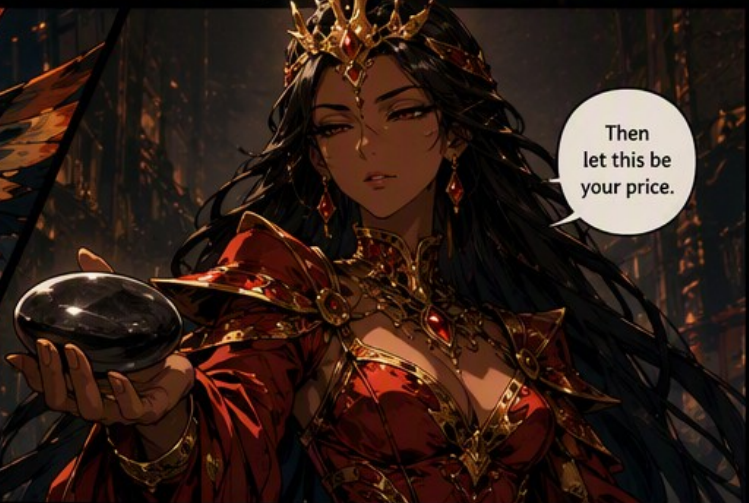


Your toll, struck true.

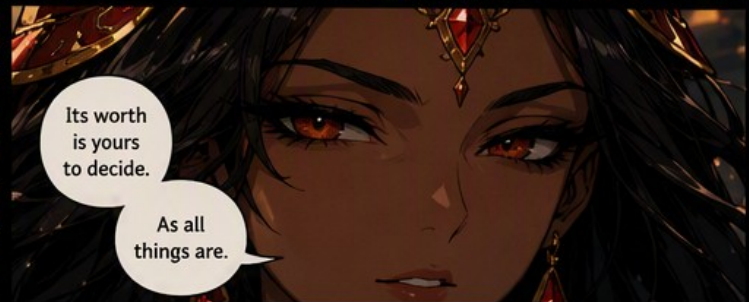
Now— your trade.



A stone? Its worth?



Then let this be your price.



Its worth is yours to decide.

As all things are.

ANOTHER
DEAD END.

FITTING.

KRRK-

HUMOR?
NOW THAT'S
A RARITY.

FLAP

THE ARCHIVES
LIBRARY SECTOR
72.14.8.6
LEVEL 9

AUTHORIZED
PERSONNEL ONLY

HM.

WHAT THE--?

FSSSSS

FWOO-OOSH

THE AIR GROWS THICK.

HUMID. HEAVY.

A SCENT NO DATABASE
EVER CATALOGED--

WOODSMOKE.
ROASTING BARBECUE.
SEA-SALT BRINE.

MEMORIES OF
A LIFE I NEVER LIVED.

THIS BOOK
DOESN'T SHOW
YOU ANYTHING.

IT MAKES YOU
REMEMBER.





YOU REALLY
KEEP A LIBRARY
BEYOND THE
EDGE OF THE
WORLD.



BEYOND
THE EDGE?

NO, MY DEAR.



THIS IS WHERE
ALL THINGS NOT
YET REALIZED
COME TO
BREATHE.

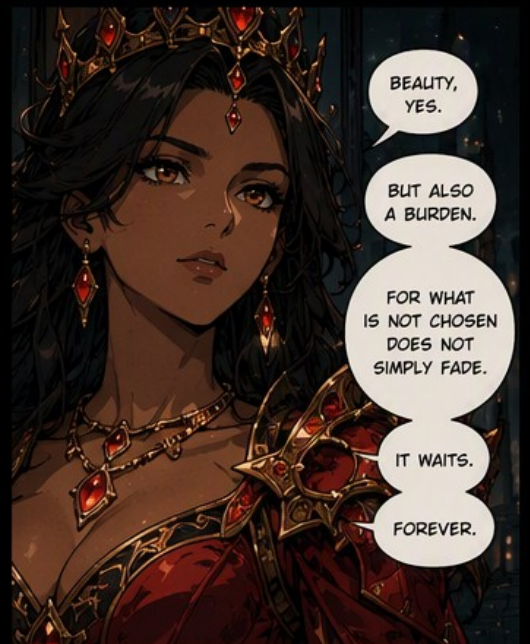


UNFILED
POTENTIAL...
WAITING.

EVERY LIFE
THAT COULD HAVE
BEEN. EVERY IDEA
NOT YET BORN.



IT'S
BEAUTIFUL.



BEAUTY,
YES.

BUT ALSO
A BURDEN.

FOR WHAT
IS NOT CHOSEN
DOES NOT
SIMPLY FADE.

IT WAITS.

FOREVER.